
Paper 2, Option 2A.1: Anglo-Saxon England and the Anglo-Norman Kingdom, c1053–1106

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of England and Normandy from the death of Earl Godwin in 1053, through the reigns of William I and William II to the re-establishment of the Anglo-Norman Kingdom by Henry I in 1107. These were dramatic years of change for England and would shape the course of its history for generations.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the nature and extent of change in government, society and the church, and of the English people's resistance to changes.

Key topics	Content
1 Late Anglo-Saxon England, c1053–66	• Monarchy and government: the power of the English monarchy; the earldoms and shires; local government; the legal system. • The economy of England: the system of taxation; royal mints and the silver penny; coastal towns and overseas trade; urbanisation and the growth of trading centres. • The house of Godwin: Harold Godwinson's succession as Earl of Wessex; the power of the Godwin siblings; the campaign against the Welsh; Harold Godwinson's embassy to Normandy; the rising against Tostig and his exile. • Early threats to Harold's throne: Edward's death and the claimants to the throne; the witan and the coronation; Harald Hardrada's invasion; reasons for, and significance of, the outcome of the battles of Gate Fulford and Stamford Bridge 1066.
2 The Norman conquest of England and extension of control in Wales and Scotland, 1066–93	• William of Normandy's invasion: William's military experience; reasons for the Norman victory at Hastings, including the leadership skills of Harold and William, Norman and English troops and tactics. • Dealing with opposition to the Normans: the submission of the earls 1066; rebellions in the south, 1067–69; the Harrying of the North; the East Anglian Rebellion; the revolt of the earls 1075. The role of foreign intervention. • Wales and Scotland: the rising of Eadric the Wild; imposing Norman control in Wales, 1067–93; Malcolm III and the Northern Rebellion; William II and Scotland, 1091–93.

Key topics	Content
3 State, church and society, 1066–1106	• Central and local government: the king's household and the chancery; the geld and the silver penny; the office of sheriff; codes of law and the local courts. • The end of the English aristocracy: changes in land tenure; the creation of new earldoms; a Norman aristocracy based on military and political service; the extent of Norman influence as revealed by the Domesday Survey 1086. • Changes in towns and villages: towns and trading patterns; village life, royal forests and the forest laws; the gradual disappearance of slavery. • The English church: the deposition of Stigand; Lanfranc's reforms; Anselm's conflict with William II; Henry I, Anselm and the investiture controversy; the Norman kings and the papacy.
4 Normandy, 1066–1106	• Reasons for William of Normandy's decision to invade England in 1066: his claim to the throne; the military power of Normandy; papal support for William's claim. • Problems in Normandy, 1066–87: conflict in Maine, 1069–73; William's defeat at the siege of Dol; resisting the demands of Robert Curthose, 1078–83; the division of the Anglo-Norman territories after William's death. • William Rufus and Robert Curthose: the position of Anglo-Norman nobles; the rebellion of 1088; William Rufus in Normandy 1091; the significance of Robert's decision to go on crusade. • Henry I and the restoration of the Anglo-Norman Kingdom, 1100–06: the defeat of Robert of Bellême; misrule in Normandy; Henry's campaign in Normandy and victory at Tinchebrai 1106; the significance of the restoration of the Anglo-Norman Kingdom.